

# The broker commission problem

Explained as simply as possible · 7 September 2026

**The short version:** when we pay a broker, sometimes we hand them the tax money and sometimes we keep it. It depends on one thing — **did the broker give us their tax invoice?**

Our app had no box to record that answer, so it had to guess. It guessed right for some commissions and wrong for others.

## 1. Two taxes, and they behave differently

Say we owe a broker **104,800** for selling an apartment. That number has two taxes wrapped up in it.

**The 14% tax** (ضريبة القيمة المضافة) — this money is *not* ours and *not* really the broker's. It belongs to the government. The only question is who hands it over.

**The 5% tax** (ضريبة الاستقطاع) — we always keep this and give it to the government ourselves. Every time. No exceptions. This one is easy.

## 2. So the only real question is about the 14%

**Did the broker give us their tax invoice?** (رفع الفاتورة الضريبية)

### Yes, they gave it to us

تم رفعها

Then we hand them the 14% too. They will pass it to the government themselves.

|                 |                |
|-----------------|----------------|
| We owe          | 104,800        |
| Take the 5%     | – 4,596        |
| <hr/>           |                |
| <b>They get</b> | <b>100,204</b> |

### No, not yet

لم ترفع

Then we hold the 14% back until they bring it. We can't hand over tax money with no invoice.

|                 |               |
|-----------------|---------------|
| We owe          | 104,800       |
| Take the 5%     | – 4,596       |
| Hold the 14%    | – 12,870      |
| <hr/>           |               |
| <b>They get</b> | <b>87,333</b> |

Same broker, same 104,800, and a difference of **12,870** — decided entirely by whether a piece of paper arrived.

### 3. What went wrong

The app had **no box** for that question. So it always applied the same answer to everybody.

First we told it "always hand over the 14%". That was right for some commissions and wrong for others. Then we told it "always hold the 14% back". Same problem, just reversed. There was no single answer that could be right, because the correct answer changes from one commission to the next.

**That is why this was so confusing.** Every time we checked a commission, the app looked either correct or broken depending on which one we happened to open. Nobody was misreading anything — the app simply could not tell the two situations apart.

### 4. What we did

We added the missing box to the screen: **تم رفع الفاتورة الضريبية**. Now the app asks instead of guessing, and it gets every commission right.

### 5. Where the 10 commissions stand

| How many | What was wrong                            | Fixed?               |
|----------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| 2        | Nothing — the app already had these right | <b>nothing to do</b> |
| 3        | Wrong amount saved                        | <b>corrected</b>     |
| 5        | Right amount, but the new box was blank   | <b>box ticked</b>    |

**The good news: nobody was paid the wrong amount.** Every commission that needed correcting still had its payment sitting unpaid, so we fixed the numbers before any money moved. Nothing needs to be recovered from any broker.

### 6. What is left

1. **Done** — the code, and all the data on the test system.
2. **To do** — put the change on the live system, run the data script, and correct two payment amounts by hand.

After that, the app and your users' Excel sheet will agree on every single commission, down to the last pound.